

Answer Keys, Rubrics & Next Steps

Everything you need to score Progress Test 1 (Class 13) and the Final Test (Class 26): answers and point values, acceptable alternatives, the errors to expect, CEFR-aligned speaking and writing rubrics, what the scores mean for each learner's next class, and how to give the news kindly.

Progress Test 1 /70

Final Test /100

Rubric bands: Not yet B2 • B2 • B2+

Confidential • teacher only

SCORING PRINCIPLES

Score meaning, not spelling, in Listening and Reading: an answer that shows understanding gets the point, even if it is misspelled ("she was tierd from standing"). In Words & Phrases the form must be right, because the form is what's being tested: *strenghten* earns the point (a spelling slip), but *strong* or *strength* does not. Circle items are right or wrong. **Rewrites** (Progress Test 3B) earn the point only when the target structure is correct; ignore small spelling slips elsewhere in the sentence. Writing and speaking use the checklists and rubrics below. Half points are not used. The tests use American English; **accept British forms everywhere** (learners may know them from British materials: *flat, holiday, queue, motorway, practise, organise, apologise, enquire, colour, Yours faithfully*).

One US/UK difference to know: Lesson 2.2 teaches that *mustn't have* is wrong for a negative deduction, and the tests follow that (*can't have* is the answer). In **American English**, though, "*He must not have heard the alarm*" is common and correct. If a learner says or writes *must not have* for a negative deduction in speaking or writing, **don't count it as an error**. *Can't have* is still the safer choice in exams and in British English.

AT A GLANCE

SECTION	PROGRESS TEST 1 (MODULES 1-4)	FINAL TEST (MODULES 1-8)
 Listening	12 items • 1 pt each • /12	15 items • 1 pt each • /15
 Words & phrases	5 linkers + 5 functions • /10	5 word formation + 5 formal words + 5 situations • /15
 Grammar	10 circle + 5 rewrites • /15	20 circle • /20
 Reading	6 Yes/No/Doesn't say + 2 short answers • /8	Article 8 + formal notice 7 • /15
 Writing	Reporting message 4 + argumentative paragraph 6 • /10	Formal inquiry email 8 + balanced argument rubric 12 • /20

SECTION	PROGRESS TEST 1 (MODULES 1-4)	FINAL TEST (MODULES 1-8)
 Speaking	Pair task, rubric $5 \times 0-3$ · /15	Interview, rubric $5 \times 0-3$ · /15
Total	/70 (written /55)	/100 (written /85)

PROGRESS TEST 1 · ANSWER KEY

◆ PART 1 · LISTENING /12

1	...the meeting had started.	listen for the weak <i>had</i> /həd/ before <i>started</i>
2	If I'd known, I'd have told you.	<i>I'd've</i> /aɪdəv/ is the clue
3	She must have forgotten.	<i>must've</i> /'mʌstəv/
4	I'm used to working nights.	the 'm and the -ing
5	six years	"about six years"
6	at a loading dock	
7	the woman who ran the training program	she "suggested applying"
8	taken a computer course	"I wish I'd taken..."
9	Priya	"what worries me is meetings"
10	Marco	"it could be argued that we have too many"
11	Both	Priya says it; Marco: "I couldn't agree more"
12	between ten and three	

◆ PART 2 · WORDS & PHRASES /10

1	Despite	6	d
2	whereas	7	b
3	due to	8	f
4	such	9	e
5	Although	10	c

Extras: *therefore* (A) and *a* (B). Items 1 and 5 are the real test: *despite* + noun (*the delay*), *although* + clause (*she had...*). A learner who swaps them has missed the main point of Lesson 4.1, so no point for either. For 3, accept *because of* or *owing to* if written in (not in the box, but correct).

◆ PART 4 · READING /8

1	Yes	fifteen years
2	No	she "had suggested applying"
3	Doesn't say	the daughter is mentioned, but not her studies
4	No	"I wasn't used to sitting in a classroom"
5	Yes	Dev, a twenty-year-old
6	Doesn't say	pay at the clinic isn't mentioned

7	She had spent the whole day on her feet (at work), so she was exhausted.	accept "she was tired from working/standing all day"
8	They made her (more) organized.	accept "she learned to be organized"

◆ PART 3 • GRAMMAR /15 • WITH THE LESSON TO REVISIT

#	ANSWER	WHY / TYPICAL WRONG ANSWER	LESSON
1	had already started	it started before we got there → past perfect; <i>has already started</i> slips out of the past time frame	1.1
2	had left	third conditional: <i>had</i> + past participle in the if-clause; never <i>would have</i> there	1.2
3	would live	mixed conditional: past cause → present result (<i>now</i>); <i>would have lived ... now</i> is the classic error	1.2
4	hadn't said	regret about a finished past event (<i>yesterday</i>) → <i>wish</i> + past perfect	1.3
5	left	<i>it's (high) time</i> + past form with a present meaning	1.3
6	didn't mention	<i>would rather</i> + another person + past simple	1.3
7	closing	<i>mind</i> + -ing	2.1
8	to buy	<i>stop to</i> = pause in order to; <i>stopped buying</i> = quit; <i>for buying</i> is never purpose	2.1
9	can't have	almost sure it didn't happen → <i>can't have</i> + past participle	2.2
10	driving	<i>get used to</i> + -ing (<i>to</i> is a preposition)	2.3
11	to be planning a merger.	subject pattern + continuous infinitive (same time, in progress). No point for <i>that it is planning</i> (wrong pattern after this subject) or <i>to planning</i> . <i>to plan a merger</i> : no point, but mention it's close.	3.1
12	to have resigned.	earlier action → <i>to have</i> + past participle. No point for <i>to resign</i> or <i>to had resigned</i> .	3.1
13	standing by the door is my new supervisor.	active → -ing participle. No point for <i>stood by the door</i> or <i>who standing</i> .	3.2
14	for missing the meeting.	<i>apologize for</i> + -ing. Accept <i>for having missed</i> / <i>for missing it</i> . No point for <i>to miss</i> or <i>that he missed</i> .	3.3

#	ANSWER	WHY / TYPICAL WRONG ANSWER	LESSON
15	have I seen such a mess.	negative inversion: auxiliary before subject. No point for <i>Never I have seen</i> .	4.2

◆ PART 5 • WRITING /10

- ◆ **A. Reporting message (4 × 1 pt).** +1 a greeting to Jordan and a friendly close. +1 **for each of three** different reporting verbs used in the **correct pattern** (max +3): *Sara apologized for being late with the report / apologized that the report was late; Mike suggested hiring a temporary assistant / suggested that we hire...; the manager warned us not to book any vacation in March; everyone agreed to work one Saturday. Said and told* earn no points here (the task asked for other verbs). No point for *suggested us to hire* or *apologized to be late*.
- ◆ **B. Argumentative paragraph (6 pts).** **Task 0–2:** 2 = a clear position + two reasons with support + one opposing point conceded and countered + a conclusion, about 120–150 words; 1 = one element missing (usually the concession) or under about 90 words. **Organization 0–1:** at least three argument phrases or linkers used correctly, including one contrast linker followed by the right grammar (*Although + clause, Despite + noun, However, + sentence*). **Range 0–1:** at least one Modules 1–4 structure used naturally (an impersonal passive, a mixed or third conditional, a participle clause, a cleft or inversion, a reporting verb). **Accuracy 0–2:** 2 = errors are occasional and never cause misunderstanding; 1 = frequent errors, but the argument is clear; 0 = meaning often lost.

Model answer A (4/4): Hi Jordan, you missed an interesting meeting! Sara apologized for being late with the report. Mike suggested hiring a temporary assistant until June, and the manager warned us not to book any vacation in March. In the end, we all agreed to work one Saturday next month. See you tomorrow!

Model answer B (6/6, 135 words): I'd like to argue that employers should let staff choose their own start and finish times. Firstly, it reduces stress. Workers who can avoid rush hour arrive calmer and more focused, and it is widely believed that less stressed staff take fewer sick days. A further point is that flexibility helps parents and caregivers, who often have to leave early for school pick-ups. It could be argued that flexible hours make teamwork harder, since colleagues are not always in the office together. That's a fair point; however, most teams only need a few shared "core hours" for meetings, for example from ten to three. What really matters is that the work gets done well, not what time someone arrives. To sum up, flexible hours cost employers very little, whereas the benefits for staff are considerable.

◆ ERRORS TO EXPECT (PROGRESS TEST 1)

- ◆ **Mixed conditionals with two pasts** ("I would have lived there now", item 3) and **would in the if-clause** ("If I would have left", item 2). Both are extremely persistent. Recycle the Lesson 1.2 "decide the time of each half" routine in warmers.
- ◆ **Present vs past wish** ("I wish I didn't say that yesterday", item 4) and **base verb after it's time we / I'd rather you** ("It's time we leave", items 5–6). Speakers of Spanish, Portuguese, French, and Italian may reach for a subjunctive-style present here.
- ◆ **Base verb after be/get used to** ("getting used to drive", item 10) and **stop + -ing / to confusion** (item 8). Learners whose languages don't mark this contrast (Chinese, Vietnamese, Japanese, Korean) need many meaningful examples, not more rules.

- ◆ **Timing in impersonal passives** ("was said to resign", item 12) and **verb patterns after reporting verbs** ("apologized to miss", "suggested me to...").
- ◆ **Despite + clause** ("Despite she had little experience...", Part 2A): the single most common B2 linker error, especially from Spanish (*a pesar de que*) and French (*malgré le fait que*) speakers who translate a full clause.
- ◆ **Writing:** an argument with no concession, or a concession with no counter ("It's true that it's hard for teams. So it's a problem."). Also *However* used to join two clauses ("However it is flexible, ..."). Praise the argument before you correct the grammar.

FINAL TEST · ANSWER KEY

◆ PART 1 · LISTENING /15

1	a mentoring program for new staff	9	organize another cleanup
2	about a third	10	I'm going to
3	helped more new staff stay	11	a) Yes, I did...
4	takes experienced staff's time	12	b) No way! What happened next?
5	a three-month trial in one department	13	c) Could you tell me where the conference room is?
6	about 30	14	a) That's a fair point; however...
7	two o'clock	15	a) Yes, I'll have finished it by Thursday afternoon.
8	had to work		

Item 6: "thirty-odd ... give or take" = about 30 (Lesson 8.2); learners who circle 13 heard "thirty" as "thirteen", a stress problem worth a quick follow-up. Item 7: "two-ish". Item 11: answer a negative question by the facts (Lesson 6.3): she *did* get it, so "Yes, I did." Item 15: future perfect + *by* (Lesson 5.1); *until* doesn't work with a deadline.

◆ PART 2 · WORDS & PHRASES /15

1	illegal	9	obtain
2	strengthen	10	apologize
3	decisively	11	There were thirty-odd people.
4	improvement	12	I look forward to hearing from you.
5	irresponsible	13	Thanks for raising that. Let me check...
6	postpone	14	You'll never guess what happened...
7	request	15	On balance, I'd argue that...
8	require		

Extra: *however* (B). Accept *apologise* for 10. Item 1: *illegal* and *inlegal* get no point (the prefix must match the sound: *il-* before *l*). Item 5: *unresponsible* gets no point. Item 12 tests *look forward to* + -ing (Lesson 2.1) in its most common real-world setting.

#	ANSWER	WHY / TYPICAL WRONG ANSWER	LESSON
1	was walking	background action in progress, interrupted by a shorter event	1.1
2	had told	third conditional: past perfect in the if-clause	1.2
3	would be	mixed conditional: past cause, present result (<i>now</i>)	1.2
4	hadn't spent	past regret (<i>last weekend</i>) → <i>wish</i> + past perfect	1.3
5	locking	<i>remember</i> + -ing = a memory of a past action; <i>remember to</i> = a duty	2.1
6	must have	confident deduction from evidence; <i>should have</i> is criticism, not deduction	2.2
7	sleeping	<i>be used to</i> + -ing	2.3
8	to have escaped	reported action earlier than the reporting → <i>to have</i> + past participle	3.1
9	Having finished	perfect participle: one action completed before the next	3.2
10	taking	<i>deny</i> + -ing (or <i>deny that he had taken</i>)	3.3
11	Despite	+ noun phrase; <i>although</i> needs a clause; <i>however</i> starts a new sentence	4.1
12	does she speak	inversion after <i>Not only</i> , with <i>do</i> -support	4.2
13	What	what-cleft: <i>What</i> + clause + <i>is</i> + focus	4.2
14	will have cooked	finished before a future point → future perfect; the time clause stays present (<i>get</i>)	5.1
15	have my hair cut	causative: object before the past participle; <i>have cut my hair</i> means I did it myself	5.2
16	All	plural noun → <i>all</i> ; <i>every</i> / <i>each</i> need a singular noun	5.3
17	is	<i>neither of</i> + plural noun takes a singular verb in formal English. The plural is common in speech; the item says "formal English"	5.3
18	much	<i>very</i> can't intensify a comparative	6.2
19	the better	both halves need <i>the</i> + comparative	6.2
20	the store opens	indirect question: statement word order, no <i>does</i>	6.3

Lesson 6.1 (word formation) is tested in Words & Phrases A. Module 7 (register, anecdotes, persuasion) is tested through Listening A and C, Words & Phrases B–C, Writing A, and the interview. Module 8 (natural speech, vague language, the debate) is tested through Listening B, Words & Phrases C, Writing B, and the interview's discussion stage.

◆ PART 4 • READING /15

1	Yes	"warned us that we would lose business"
2	No	"Output has stayed the same"
3	Yes	sick days fell by almost a third
4	Doesn't say	her job title is given, not how long
5	No	"works far better in office jobs"
6	The extra day off gives them time to rest, run errands, and deal with family matters.	any one idea is enough
7	It ran a three-month trial with one team.	accept "tested it with one team first"
8	Meetings were cut to 30 minutes / staff blocked out "quiet hours".	either
9	about six weeks	
10	Saturday, April 12	accept "April 12"
11	5 p.m.	accept "five o'clock"
12	No	one elevator stays in service

◆ PART 5 • WRITING /20

- ◆ **A. Formal inquiry email (8 × 1 pt).** +1 a formal greeting (*Dear Ms. Patel,*). +1 the purpose in the first line (*I am writing to inquire about...*). +1 a relevant detail about the writer (job, experience, reason for interest). +1 a first polite question correctly formed (indirect: statement order, no *do/does/did*). +1 a second polite question correctly formed, ideally with a different opener or *if/whether*. +1 formal register held throughout: no contractions, no slang, no emojis. +1 a polite request frame or closing line (*I would be grateful if you could... · I look forward to hearing from you.*). +1 a sign-off that matches (*Sincerely, / Yours sincerely,* + full name).
- ◆ **B. Balanced argument (12).** Score with the **writing rubric** below: four criteria × 0–3.

Model answer A (8/8, 109 words): Dear Ms. Patel, I am writing to inquire about the evening course in Workplace Communication advertised on your website. I currently work as a shift supervisor at a distribution center, and I would like to improve my presentation and email skills. Could you tell me when the next course starts and how many evenings a week it runs? I was also wondering whether participants receive a certificate at the end, as this would be useful for my career. Finally, I would be grateful if you could let me know the total cost and whether my employer can pay directly. I look forward to hearing from you. Sincerely, Leila Haddad

A sign-off note: Lesson 7.1 teaches the American sign-off *Sincerely*, (standard after any formal greeting) and mentions the British rule (*Yours sincerely* after a name, *Yours faithfully* after *Dear Sir or Madam*). Accept *Sincerely*, *Yours sincerely*, and *Best regards*., *Yours faithfully* after a named greeting is the one slip the lesson flagged: no point for the sign-off, and mention it kindly.

13	Residents with limited mobility who need help (on April 12), by Friday, April 4.	both parts needed for the point
14	Outside working hours	accept "evenings or weekends", "before 8 or after 5"
15	"We apologize in advance for any noise or inconvenience." / "Please do not hesitate to contact us."	either, copied accurately enough to recognize

◆ WRITING B · MODEL ANSWER (B2+, 12/12, 166 WORDS)

The question we need to consider is whether employers should pay for their staff to take training courses. The strongest argument in favor is that training benefits the company as much as the worker. Staff who learn new skills make fewer mistakes and are far more likely to stay, and replacing an employee is often much more expensive than training one. Not only does training improve performance, but it also shows staff that they are valued. On the other hand, it is often argued that employees may use the new skills to find a better job elsewhere. Admittedly, some will leave. That said, if companies refused to train anyone, they would lose even more people to employers who do. Another concern is cost, especially for small businesses; however, many courses are short, online, or partly funded by the government. On balance, I would argue that employers should pay for training, at least for skills connected to the job. What really matters is that both sides benefit.

◆ ERRORS TO EXPECT (FINAL TEST)

- ◆ **Wrong aspect in the future** (14: "will cook" for a finished action) and **will in time clauses** ("by the time you will get home"). Link this to the B1 rule they already know.
- ◆ **The causative vs the past perfect** (15: "I'm going to have cut my hair"). Ask "Who does the cutting?"
- ◆ **Determiner agreement** (16–17: "Every employees", "Neither of the plans are"). The plural verb after *neither of* is normal in relaxed speech, so don't over-correct it in the interview.
- ◆ **"very cheaper"** (18), **one *the* in parallel comparisons** (19), and **question order inside indirect questions** (20 and Listening 13: "Could you tell me where is..."). Speakers of languages that keep question order in embedded questions (Spanish, Arabic, Tagalog, and others) will do this for a long time. It rarely blocks meaning, but it matters in formal settings.
- ◆ **Writing A:** a formal opening followed by an informal close ("Thanks! Cheers"), contractions, and direct questions that sound like demands ("What is the price?"). **Writing B:** arguments listed but never weighed, a

missing conclusion, or a conclusion that ignores the concession. Many learners also overuse *However* at the start of every sentence.

- ◆ **Listening B** (items 6 and 10): *thirty/thirteen* and the relaxed forms (*gonna, wanna, lemme*). Accept only the right answer, but treat misses as a listening next step, not a grammar problem.

SPEAKING RUBRIC · BOTH TESTS

Five criteria, each 0–3 (total /15). 0 = no response, or only L1. The bands follow the CEFR qualitative aspects of spoken language (range, accuracy, fluency, interaction, coherence, phonological control) and sociolinguistic appropriateness (register). The **B2** column paraphrases the Council of Europe's B2 descriptors (*CEFR Companion Volume*, 2020). For the progress test, judge against Modules 1–4 language only.

CRITERION	NOT YET B2 (1)	B2 (2)	B2+ STRONG (3)
Task & coherence /3	B1 level: tells a story or gives an opinion as a simple list of points; reasons are brief; the long turn has little shape or runs out quickly.	Gives clear, detailed descriptions and develops a viewpoint with supporting points and relevant examples; explains the advantages and disadvantages of options. Links ideas with a range of connectors, although a long turn may be a little "jumpy".	Develops the long turn and the argument systematically, highlighting the key points; stories have a hook, layers of background, and a landed ending; conclusions follow clearly from the reasons given.
Range & register /3	Enough language for familiar topics, but searches for words often, repeats the same phrases, and can't adjust formality.	A sufficient range to describe, give viewpoints, and develop arguments without much obvious searching for words, using some complex sentence forms. Can express themselves appropriately in formal and informal situations and change register when the situation changes.	Wide, flexible range (emphasis, hedging, reporting verbs, precise comparison) chosen to suit the point; switches register confidently and naturally, including relaxed, vague language where it fits.
Accuracy /3	Good control of B1 structures, but B2 forms (conditionals, past modals, passives, verb patterns) often break down; errors sometimes cause confusion.	A relatively high degree of grammatical control. Errors (articles, prepositions, an occasional tense or pattern slip) do not cause misunderstanding, and the learner corrects many of them.	Consistently good control of the course's structures, including mixed conditionals, impersonal passives, and future perfect; slips are rare and usually self-corrected at once.

CRITERION	NOT YET B2 (1)	B2 (2)	B2+ STRONG (3)
Interaction /3	Answers and responds, but struggles to keep an exchange going or to respond to disagreement without help.	Starts, maintains, and closes discussion naturally, taking turns appropriately. Helps the discussion along, invites others in, and responds to counter-arguments, conceding a point before countering it.	Handles push-back with ease: concedes, refines, and defends a position persuasively; asks probing follow-up questions; negotiates a compromise or solution in the role-play.
Pronunciation & fluency /3	Understandable, but long pauses to plan, flat stress, or unclear sounds make the listener work hard in longer turns.	Produces stretches of language at a fairly even tempo; may hesitate while searching for patterns and expressions, but there are few noticeably long pauses. Stress and intonation are generally appropriate; accent has little or no effect on intelligibility.	Speaks fluently and spontaneously; uses stress and intonation to highlight key points and to sound polite or relaxed as needed; weak forms and linking sound natural.

WRITING RUBRIC · FINAL TEST PART 5B

Four criteria, each 0–3 (total /12). 0 = nothing written, or nothing in English. At B2 the learner can write an essay that develops an argument, giving reasons in support of or against a particular point of view and explaining the advantages and disadvantages of various options, and can synthesize information and arguments from different sources (paraphrased from the CEFR). An assigned side is fine: score the argument, never the opinion.

CRITERION	NOT YET B2 (1)	B2 (2)	B2+ STRONG (3)
Task & content /3	Under about 120 words, or one-sided: arguments for <i>or</i> against, with no weighing; no clear conclusion.	150–180 words; the question introduced; two arguments for and two against, with reasons or examples; at least one concession answered; a conclusion that takes a position.	A well-developed, balanced argument: points supported with specific examples, the strongest objection answered convincingly, and a conclusion that follows logically from the weighing.
Organization & linking /3	Ideas in a list; linkers repeated (<i>and, but, However, However</i>) or used with the wrong grammar.	Clear structure (introduction, for, against, conclusion); a range of linkers used accurately (<i>Although, Despite, whereas, Admittedly... That said, On balance</i>).	Paragraphing and signposting guide the reader smoothly; linkers are varied and precise, and the concede-and-counter move reads naturally.

CRITERION	NOT YET B2 (1)	B2 (2)	B2+ STRONG (3)
Range /3	Repeats the same words and B1 structures; little formal vocabulary.	Enough topic vocabulary; several B2 structures (a conditional, an impersonal passive, a participle clause, a comparison, an emphasis structure); a suitably neutral-to-formal register.	Varied vocabulary, including accurate word-formation choices, and B2 structures used naturally for effect (inversion, cleft, mixed conditional); register consistent throughout.
Accuracy /3	Frequent errors that make the reader stop and reread.	A relatively high degree of control; errors don't cause misunderstanding; punctuation of connectors mostly correct.	Few errors, mostly small slips; complex sentences and punctuation well controlled.

WHAT THE SCORES MEAN

◆ PROGRESS TEST 1 (/70): A DIAGNOSIS, NOT A VERDICT

SCORE	WHAT IT TELLS YOU	WHAT TO DO IN WEEKS 7-13
56-70	Strong. Modules 1-4 are secure.	Give the stretch task in every lesson and start nudging toward C1: ask for a second example, a more precise word, a counter-argument. Ask them to chair discussions and to give quieter classmates the first turn.
42-55	On track, with gaps in one or two sections.	Point the learner to the online lessons behind their missed items (use the lesson column above). Recycle those points in warmers.
28-41	Needs targeted support.	A short one-to-one: which part felt hard? Agree on two online lessons to redo with 🎧 Listen, usually Lessons 1.2 and 3.1. Use the support options in every class. Check attendance.
0-27	Something is getting in the way.	Talk privately and gently. Check vision, hearing, literacy, attendance, and life stress, and whether the learner was placed at the right level. Re-check with the shared placement test ; Independent English (B1) may be a better fit for now. Keep them welcome while you decide together.

Class analysis: add up each section for the whole class and divide by the number of learners. A section average under 60% is a class problem, not an individual one. Build a 5-10 minute recycle into the warmers of Classes 14-19: for example, a "Rewrite it" relay (active → impersonal passive) if rewrites 11-12 are weak, which also sets up the causative in Lesson 5.2; or a "turning points" chain (*If I hadn't..., I wouldn't be...*) if items 2-3 are weak.

◆ FINAL TEST (/100): GRADE TO OUTCOME

OUTCOME	GUIDELINE	WHAT TO TELL THE LEARNER AND PROGRAM
Ready for C1	70+ total and Speaking 10+/15 (mostly B2 or B2+ on the rubric).	Recommend Advanced English (C1 Advanced) , free online at rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-c1/ . Learners at 88+ with Speaking 13+ are strong B2+ and can move quickly through the first C1 module; tell them so.
C1 with a review plan	55–69 total with Speaking 8+ , or 70+ with Speaking 8–9 .	Move on to C1 with a written review plan : the 3–4 B2 online lessons behind their weakest items (see the lesson column), done with 🎧 Listen before C1 Week 3. Lessons 1.2, 3.1, 4.1, and 6.3 are the usual ones. Speaking 8–9 learners also benefit from a conversation or debate group.
Repeat B2 with support	Below 55 total , or Speaking 7 or below .	Recommend a second lap of B2, framed as consolidation and not failure ("The second time, you'll use these structures without thinking, and your arguments will be sharper."). Add a conversation group or a volunteer tutor if your program has them. If the score was very low, re-check with the shared placement test.
Literacy pathway	Speaking 10+ and Listening 11+/15 , but Reading + Writing under 18/35 .	Oral English is ready for C1 and literacy is the barrier. Don't hold them back for literacy alone. Recommend C1 plus a reading and writing class or tutor. If C1 can't support them, repeat B2 with a literacy focus and say clearly why.
Specialist tracks	Any learner with a clear exam or workplace goal, usually 55+ total.	IELTS Academic Preparation (rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-ielts/) for learners who need a test score for study, professional registration, or immigration; a secure B2 is roughly the level of an IELTS band 5.5–6.5, so learners aiming at 7+ usually need C1 as well. Business English (rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-business/) for learners who want meetings, negotiation, and professional writing. Both can run alongside C1 or instead of it, depending on the learner's goal and time.

These are **guidelines**. Your thirteen weeks of observation count as much as one test on one day, especially the Class 12 and Class 25 review projects. A learner who was ill, anxious, or grieving on test day deserves a re-test or a quick re-check with the shared placement test before any "repeat" recommendation. Record the outcome and a one-line reason for your program.

GIVING FEEDBACK KINDLY

◆ PRINCIPLES

- ◆ **Private, always.** Never read scores aloud or return papers in score order.

◆ PHRASES THAT WORK AT B2

You did a great job. 🌟

- ◆ **Strength first, then one next step.** One concrete step, not a list of errors.
- ◆ **Name the progress.** Compare with Week 1, not with classmates.
- ◆ **Fluency before accuracy.** Praise what they *achieved* (a persuasive point, a smooth concession, a real change of register) before you mention a form.
- ◆ **Accuracy and range.** At B2, the next step can be a wider choice, not just a correction: "You said *good* five times. Try *effective* or *worthwhile*."
- ◆ **Written note to take home,** with the lesson number and URL.
- ◆ **Adults decide.** Offer the recommendation and the reason, and let the learner choose when the program allows it.

Your argument was really persuasive.

The way you conceded that point, then came back with a stronger one, was excellent.

You switched from formal to informal so naturally.

Next step: "I wish I **had** known", not "I wish I would have known".

Do Lesson 1.2 again at home. Click  Listen and shadow it.

Your next class: Advanced English (C1). 

One more B2 class. It'll feel easier the second time.

I'm proud of you.

SAY: *Thirteen weeks ago we were layering past tenses. Yesterday you won a debate!*

SAY: *Your speaking is ready for C1. Reading and writing need more time, so let's find a writing class to go with it.*

AVOID

Red ink everywhere, percentages without meaning ("62%"), the word "fail", comparisons ("Maria got 90"), and correcting a learner's accent as though it were an error. Don't grade opinions: a learner who argues the opposite of your view, clearly and politely, or who argued an assigned side, has done exactly what B2 asks. If a learner cries or goes quiet, pause the conversation and come back to it. The number can wait.